

Group Boycotting

Group boycotting involves two or more businesses conspiring against another. In the real estate profession, this can occur, for instance, when two or more brokers or agents refuse to cooperate and split commissions with another one, or when several brokerages in a certain area agree to stop running advertisements in a local newspaper. Some additional types of group boycotting include:

- Boycotting a competitor
- Boycotting a supplier or vendor
- Discussing or agreeing to the different treatment of a competitor as a group

Group boycotting often involves brokers agreeing to not show the listings of limited services firms, hoping to drive them and their competitive pricing out of the market. In whatever form it takes, group boycotting is a violation of antitrust law.

If you and other agents from the same firm decide not to do business with a certain appraiser because he does shoddy work, that's not a group boycott. That sort of action is allowed under federal law.